

TIMELESS SKILLS FOR ALL AGES

SOME COMPETENCIES WILL ALWAYS STAY RELEVANT, AND IT DOES NOT TAKE 1000 HOURS TO LEARN THEM.

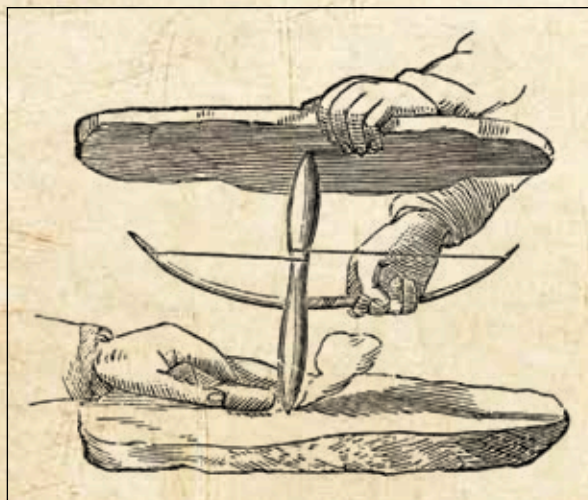
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No matter what advancements are made by technology, it is a good idea to learn how to make do without the benefits.

Technology is fallible, batteries can die, and because of Murphy's Law, it always helps to be prepared. If there is a zombie apocalypse or you get stranded on a deserted island, these skills can turn out to be incredibly useful. It is never too late to learn.

STARTING A FIRE

This is one of the most basic, ancient and even sacred skills. The ability to control fire is what kickstarted the growth of human culture and technology. Even if you have a lighter or matches, it can be difficult to maintain and control a fire. The basic structure involves making a ring of stones to contain the fire, and starting off with a base of sticks. Hay, light grass, reeds or paper can be



A bow drill

used as kindling to get the fire going. Larger sticks can be piled on top as required. It is a good idea to keep a supply of firewood ready before starting.

The most tried and tested method to start a fire without matches or a lighter, is to make a notch or hole using a knife in a piece of wood. Then, rapidly rotate a circular stick within the notch or hole.

The friction heats up the wood enough to start a fire, but this is time consuming. Another way to do this is to attach a cord along a bent piece of pliable bow, forming a bow drill. This makes the process of starting a fire faster usually. The cord can be made of string, strong vines or a ripped ribbon from a plastic bottle. Another method involves rubbing a 9 volt battery on steel wool. The bottom of a soda can or a magnifying glass can be used as a parabolic mirror to focus the Sun rays. Lenses can be fashioned from water balloons or carved out of chunks of ice. Always

remember to keep water handy, and make sure that a fire is extinguished before you leave the area, to prevent wildfires.

DIRECTION AND NAVIGATION

Mapping applications may not always show the best route, so it is a good idea to be able to read the maps yourself and